

The Globe Theatre

William Shakespeare, the most famous of all playwrights, acted on the Globe's wooden stage.

The theater was rebuilt and opened again in June 1997.

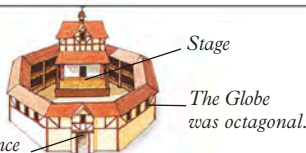
Musicians played on this balcony.

There was no scenery on the stage.

When the flag was raised, people knew that a play was going to be performed.

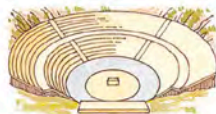
This model of the Globe Theatre has been cut in half to let you see inside.

Most of the audience stood around the stage. These "groundlings" got wet when it rained.

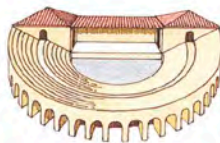


Setting the scene

Theatres come in all sorts of shapes and sizes. Early ones were out in the open. Most modern stages have roofs so that plays can be staged when it is raining.



Greek theater
200 BCE



Roman theater
100 CE



Elizabethan theater
16th century



"Modern" theater
19th century